

The following are some keys to scroll through the history and jump to either end:

UP arrow key: Scrolls backwards in history.

CTRL + p: Scrolls backwards in history.

DOWN arrow key: Scrolls forward in history.

CTRL + n: Scrolls forward in history.

ALT+Shift+.: Jumps to the end of the history.

ALT+Shift+;: Jumps to the beginning of the history.

Variables configuration

The behaviour of the history log file is controlled by a few variables and these can be found or can be added to the `.bashrc` file. So let us have a look at the `.bashrc` file. This is present in the home directory. To view its contents, open a terminal and fire up the `cat` command followed by the name (i.e., `cat .bashrc`) or simply navigate to the home directory and press `CTRL+h` and open it with the text editor. Let's review some of the variables.

HISTCONTROL: Now, it would make sense if you keep some of the variables' values as they are, by default, like the value of the variable `HISTCONTROL=ignoreboth` (which will avoid duplication of commands) and `shopt -s histappend` (which will append newly executed commands to the previous history).

Although `HISTCONTROL=ignoreboth` is good enough for us, some of the other possible values for `HISTCONTROL` along with the syntax are:

```
[bash]$ export HISTCONTROL=ignoredups
```

(To eliminate duplicates, set `HISTCONTROL` to `ignoredups`)

```
[bash]$ export HISTCONTROL=erasedups
```

(To eliminate duplicates across the whole history, set the `HISTCONTROL` to `erasedups`)

```
[bash]$ export HISTCONTROL=ignorespace
```

(When you execute a command, you can instruct `history` to ignore the command by setting `HISTCONTROL` to `ignorespace` and typing a space in front of the command)

HISTSIZE and HISTFILESIZE: Some of the other variables in the `.bashrc` file are `HISTSIZE` and `HISTFILESIZE`.

- `HISTSIZE` is the number of lines of the command to store in the history 'list' (i.e., in the memory)
- `HISTFILESIZE` is the number of lines of the command to store in history 'file' (i.e., the actual history file)

These variables are set to an integer value. To change these values, use the following command:

```
[bash]$ export HISTSIZE=2000
```

```
[bash]$ export HISTFILESIZE=2000
```

`HISTSIZE` can be used to disable the use of history.

If you want to disable history all together and don't want `bash` shell to remember the commands you've typed, set the `HISTSIZE` to 0 as shown below:

```
[bash]$ export HISTSIZE=0
```

Note that now history will not display anything.

HISTFILE: The `HISTFILE` variable can be used to store the history log to an alternate file. To do so, execute the following command:

```
[bash]$ export HISTFILE=.bash_alternate_history
```

Now the history will be stored in `.bash_alternate_history`.

HISTTIMEFORMAT=%F %T: Typically, when you type `history` from the command line, it displays the previously executed commands, but sometimes it may be beneficial to display the time stamp along with the command. To do so, execute the following command:

```
[bash]$ export HISTTIMEFORMAT='%F %T '
```

Now, on executing the `history` command, the execution date and time along with the command will be displayed:

```
[bash]$ history
16 2014-11-09 17:51:11 ls
17 2014-11-09 17:54:32 cd ..
13 2014-11-09 17:57:37 pwd
14 2014-11-09 17:58:47 history
```

HISTIGNORE: Sometimes you may not want your history to remember some basic commands such as `ls`. Use `HISTIGNORE` to specify all the commands that you want to ignore from the history. Please note that adding `ls` to the `HISTIGNORE` ignores only `ls` and not `ls -l`. So, we have to be specific about the command that we would like to ignore from the history. Thus, executing the following command will ignore `ls` and `ls -l` commands:

```
[bash]$ export HISTIGNORE="ls:ls -l:"
```



Note: 1) Sometimes you may be required to re-login for the changes to take effect.

2) To make permanent changes, add the variables with their values in the `.bashrc` file and re-login for the changes to take effect.